5 Disjoint Set: Sub-linear-time processing of disjoint sets

This chapter covers

- Solving a problem: how to keep a set partitioned into disjoint sets, merging partitions dynamically
- Describing an API for a data structure for disjoint sets
- Providing a simple linear-time solution for all methods
- Improving the running time by using the right underlying data structure
- Adding easy-to-implement heuristics to get *quasi-constant* running time
- Recognizing use cases where the best solution is needed for performance